Color & Palettes

181 terms · name, then the phrase to paste · Workbook Library

Harmony & theory

Monochromatic monochromatic palette: tints and shades of a single [blue], separated by value only

Analogous analogous palette of neighboring hues: [gold, amber and burnt orange]

Accented analogous accented analogous palette: [amber, gold and cream] with a single small [teal] accent as the only cool color

Complementary complementary palette: [deep blue] dominant with small [orange] accents

Split-complementary split-complementary scheme: [blue] as the base, with [red-orange] and [yellow-orange] accents

Triadic triadic color scheme of [red], [yellow] and [blue], with [red] dominant

Tetradic tetradic (double complementary) scheme, one dominant hue and three muted supporting hues

Square square color scheme of four evenly spaced hues on a calm off-white background

Achromatic achromatic palette: black, white and grays only, no hue at all

Neutral plus one accent neutral palette of warm grays with a single [cobalt] accent used only for the most important element

60-30-10 rule follow a 60-30-10 split: [cream] 60% of the area, [forest green] 30%, [brass] 10% for accents

Discordant deliberately clashing palette: hot pink against orange and acid green, bold and intentional

Hue keep every color within a narrow hue range around [amber]

Saturation low-saturation palette overall, with only [one element] fully saturated

Value strong value structure: a few big light and dark shapes that read clearly even in grayscale

Tints, tones & shades build the palette from tints, tones and shades of a single [teal]

Color temperature warm colors for the foreground subject, cool colors for the background so it recedes

Warm-shifted & cool-shifted warm-shift the [teal] toward green so it sits comfortably in the warm palette

High key & low key high-key image: mostly light tones, soft shadows, airy and bright

Simultaneous contrast test each color against its actual background; adjust for simultaneous contrast

Vibrating colors use vibrating complementary colors of equal lightness for an op-art shimmer (never for body text)

Color weight balance color weight: one small saturated [red] shape offsets the large pale [blue] field

Color roles assign each color one role: [color] for [background], [color] for [subject], [color] for [shadows], [color] for [accents only]

Limited palette strictly limited palette of [four] colors; every tone mixed only from these

Moods & places

Pastel soft pastel palette (light, low-saturation tints) with one deep [plum] for outlines and text

Muted muted, dusty palette; no color fully saturated

Earth tones earth-tone palette: terracotta, ochre, olive, sand and warm brown

Jewel tones jewel-tone palette of emerald, sapphire, ruby and amethyst with gold accents

Neon glowing neon accents in magenta, cyan and lime on a near-black background

Bright primaries bold primary palette: saturated red, yellow and blue on clean white

Black & white black and white with deep blacks and bright highlights, rich midtone gradation

Sepia & vintage sepia-toned palette of warm browns and aged cream, like an old photograph

Sun-bleached sun-bleached palette: faded, chalky, warm-washed colors with no true blacks

Dark & moody dark and moody palette: deep charcoals and forest greens, small pools of warm light

Light & airy light and airy palette: whites and pale neutrals with soft touches of [blush]

Tonal neutrals tonal neutral palette of cream, oatmeal, taupe and stone, close in value

Autumn autumn palette: rust, mustard, burgundy, burnt orange and olive

Winter cold winter palette: icy blue, silver gray, slate and snow white

Spring spring palette: fresh leaf green, blossom pink, butter yellow and clear sky blue

Summer summer palette: turquoise water, coral, sunshine yellow and warm sand

Desert desert palette: sand, terracotta, sage, dusty rose under a pale hot sky

Coastal coastal palette: navy, sea-glass green, sand and crisp white with a small red accent

Forest forest palette: deep pine, moss, fern green, bark brown and misty gray

Tropical tropical palette: lush jungle greens with flashes of hibiscus pink, mango orange and parrot blue

Sunset sunset palette in bands: peach, coral, magenta, violet fading to indigo

Night city night palette: deep navy and black with warm yellow windows and a few colored lights

Dusty Americana dusty Americana palette: faded denim blue, rust, prairie gold, sagebrush and bone white

Named aesthetics

Vaporwave vaporwave palette: pastel pink, mint, lavender and cyan with a soft retro-web feel

Synthwave synthwave palette: hot magenta and cyan on deep purple-black, striped orange-to-pink sunset sun

Cyberpunk cyberpunk palette: acid yellow, cyan and hot pink neon against wet black and teal shadows

Y2K Y2K palette: chrome silver, icy blue, bubblegum pink and lime, glossy translucent plastic

Memphis Memphis design palette: mint, pink, yellow, cobalt and black, with squiggles and confetti

70s retro 70s retro palette: harvest gold, burnt orange, avocado green and chocolate brown in rounded stripes

Mid-century modern mid-century modern palette: mustard, teal, tangerine and walnut brown on warm off-white

Art Deco Art Deco palette: black, metallic gold and cream with deep emerald accents

Bauhaus Bauhaus palette: primary red, yellow and blue with black on off-white, hard geometric shapes

Swiss style Swiss style palette: white, black and a single signal red

Scandinavian Scandinavian palette: white, pale birch wood, soft gray and muted sage

Japandi Japandi palette: warm stone, charcoal, natural oak, clay and muted olive

Dark academia dark academia palette: oxblood, forest green, tweed brown, parchment and ink black

Cottagecore cottagecore palette: cream, sage, buttercup yellow, faded rose and linen

Solarpunk solarpunk palette: leaf green, solar gold, clear sky blue and white with warm wood

Barbiecore Barbiecore palette: saturated hot pink, bubblegum and magenta, pink on pink

Millennial pink millennial pink palette: muted salmon-pink with warm gray, cream and brass

Acid graphics acid graphics palette: acid green and hot orange on black, with chrome highlights

Pop art pop art palette: flat primary red, yellow, cyan and hot pink with thick black outlines and Ben-Day dots

Ukiyo-e ukiyo-e palette: Prussian blue, indigo, soft vermilion and pale ochre on cream paper

Risograph risograph palette: fluorescent pink and medium blue inks overprinting to purple, slight misregistration, grain

Film & grading

Kodak Portra shot on Kodak Portra 400: soft contrast, warm natural skin tones, gentle pastel color, fine grain

Kodak Ektar shot on Kodak Ektar 100: vivid saturated blues and reds, crisp, ultra-fine grain

Fuji Velvia Fuji Velvia slide film look: intensely saturated greens and magentas, deep blacks, high contrast

Fujifilm cool greens Fujifilm color: cool minty greens, cyan-leaning skies, clean whites, soft grain

Kodachrome Kodachrome look: rich reds, deep blues, warm yellows, dense shadows, mid-century archival feel

CineStill 800T CineStill 800T at night: cool teal shadows, red halation glow around every light source, visible grain

Technicolor three-strip Technicolor look: lush saturated primaries, candy reds, glowing skin, painterly sets

Two-strip color two-strip color film look: only orange-red and cyan-green tones, no true blues or yellows

Polaroid Polaroid instant film look: soft, washed color, cyan-tinted shadows, warm highlights, white frame

Bleach bypass bleach bypass look: desaturated, silvery, high contrast with gritty blacks

Cross-processed cross-processed look: yellow-green highlights, blue-magenta shadows, punchy contrast

Cyanotype cyanotype print: Prussian blue and white only, soft edges, paper texture

Teal & orange teal and orange grade: warm orange skin and highlights, teal shadows and background

Split toning split toning: warm golden highlights and cool blue-green shadows

Faded & lifted blacks faded matte look with lifted blacks, soft charcoal shadows, gentle contrast

Crushed blacks crushed blacks: deep inky shadows with no detail, high contrast

Desaturated heavily desaturated grade, just a hint of color remaining, cool and somber

Selective color black and white image with only the [red umbrella] in full color

Green tint cold green-tinted grade like fluorescent light, uneasy and artificial

Yellow-green urban grimy yellow-green grade, sodium-vapor light, desaturated browns, tense and paranoid

Pastel symmetry grade Wes Anderson style grade: soft pinks, mint and mustard, low contrast, flat even light, centered symmetry

Cyan & magenta night night portrait lit with saturated cyan from one side and magenta from the other, glowing skin

Day for night day-for-night grade: deep blue, underexposed daylight that reads as bright moonlight

Monochrome tint monochrome image tinted entirely in [deep red], like a toned darkroom print

Golden hour golden hour light: low warm sun, long shadows, glowing amber edges

Blue hour blue hour: deep blue twilight sky with warm glowing windows and street lights

Overcast overcast flat light: soft shadowless illumination, muted cool colors

Harsh noon sun harsh midday sun: hard short shadows, bleached highlights, saturated hot color

Candlelight & tungsten lit only by warm candlelight: deep orange glow falling off into dark shadows

Neon night neon night lighting: magenta and cyan sign glow reflecting on wet pavement

Backlit haze backlit by a low sun, hazy glow lifting the shadows, soft flare, subject partly dissolved in light

Fog & atmosphere layers fading into mist: each distant layer paler and bluer (atmospheric perspective)

Named palettes

Catppuccin Mocha Catppuccin Mocha color theme: background #1e1e2e, text #cdd6f4, accents #f38ba8, #a6e3a1, #f9e2af, #89b4fa, #cba6f7, #94e2d5

Catppuccin Latte Catppuccin Latte color theme: background #eff1f5, text #4c4f69, accents #d20f39, #40a02b, #df8e1d, #1e66f5, #8839ef, #179299

Dracula Dracula color theme: background #282a36, text #f8f8f2, accents #ff79c6, #50fa7b, #f1fa8c, #8be9fd, #bd93f9, #ffb86c

Nord Nord color theme: background #2e3440, text #d8dee9, accents #bf616a, #a3be8c, #ebcb8b, #81a1c1, #b48ead, #88c0d0

Solarized Solarized color theme: background #002b36, text #839496, accents #dc322f, #859900, #b58900, #268bd2, #6c71c4, #2aa198

Gruvbox Gruvbox color theme: background #282828, text #ebdbb2, accents #fb4934, #b8bb26, #fabd2f, #83a598, #d3869b, #8ec07c

Tokyo Night Tokyo Night color theme: background #1a1b26, text #c0caf5, accents #f7768e, #9ece6a, #e0af68, #7aa2f7, #bb9af7, #7dcfff

Rosé Pine Rosé Pine color theme: background #191724, text #e0def4, accents #eb6f92, #31748f, #f6c177, #9ccfd8, #c4a7e7, #ebbcba

One Dark One Dark color theme: background #282c34, text #abb2bf, accents #e06c75, #98c379, #e5c07b, #61afef, #c678dd, #56b6c2

Monokai Monokai color theme: background #272822, text #f8f8f2, accents #f92672, #a6e22e, #e6db74, #66d9ef, #ae81ff, #fd971f

Everforest Everforest color theme: background #2d353b, text #d3c6aa, accents #e67e80, #a7c080, #dbbc7f, #7fbbb3, #d699b6, #83c092

Kanagawa Kanagawa color theme: background #1f1f28, text #dcd7ba, accents #c34043, #98bb6c, #e6c384, #7e9cd8, #957fb8, #7aa89f

Grand Budapest Grand Budapest Hotel palette: peach #f1bb7b, coral pink #fd6467, oxblood #5b1a18, burnt orange #d67236

Darjeeling Limited Darjeeling Limited palette: red #ff0000, teal #00a08a, saffron #f2ad00, orange #f98400, sky blue #5bbcd6

Moonrise Kingdom Moonrise Kingdom palette: powder blue #85d4e3, pink #f4b5bd, khaki olive #9c964a, sand #cdc08c, butter yellow #fad77b

Game Boy original Game Boy palette, only four shades of green: #0f380f, #306230, #8bac0f, #9bbc0f

PICO-8 pixel art using only the PICO-8 16-color palette

Pantone Color of the Year built around Pantone's [Mocha Mousse #a47864] as the hero color, with warm neutrals

Named colors & pigments

International Klein Blue International Klein Blue (#002fa7) as a deep, vibrating field of color

Tiffany Blue Tiffany Blue (#81d8d0)

Hermès orange Hermès orange (#f37021)

Rosso Corsa Rosso Corsa (#d40000)

British racing green British racing green (#004225)

Majorelle Blue Majorelle Blue (#6050dc)

Shocking pink Shocking pink (#fc0fc0)

Barbie pink Barbie pink (#e0218a)

Safety orange Safety orange (#ff7900)

Coca-Cola red Coca-Cola red (#f40009)

Off-white warm off-white (#f0eee9) instead of pure white

Rich black rich near-black (#14161a) instead of pure black

Ultramarine Ultramarine (#120a8f)

Prussian blue Prussian blue (#003153)

Vermilion Vermilion (#e34234)

Yellow ochre Yellow ochre (#cc7722)

Burnt sienna Burnt sienna (#e97451)

Raw umber Raw umber (#826644)

Viridian Viridian (#40826d)

Payne's gray Payne's gray (#536878)

Naples yellow Naples yellow (#fada5e)

Cadmium red Cadmium red (#e30022)

Alizarin crimson Alizarin crimson (#e32636)

Tyrian purple Tyrian purple (#66023c)

Verdigris Verdigris (#43b3ae)

Celadon Celadon (#ace1af)

Indigo Indigo (#2a3a6b)

Egyptian blue Egyptian blue (#1034a6)

Gradients & treatments

Linear gradient smooth linear gradient from [deep violet] to [warm coral], no muddy midpoint

Radial gradient radial gradient glow from a bright center fading to dark edges

Conic gradient conic gradient sweeping through the full hue circle

Mesh gradient soft mesh gradient of [peach, lilac and aqua] blending in organic patches

Aurora gradient aurora gradient: large blurred drifting color orbs of [teal, violet and magenta] on near-black

Grainy gradient grainy gradient from [orange] to [pink] with visible fine noise texture

Gradient map gradient map the image: shadows to [deep indigo], midtones to [magenta], highlights to [peach]

Duotone duotone treatment: every image in [deep navy] for darks and [hot pink] for lights

Tritone tritone treatment: [black] shadows, [teal] midtones, [cream] highlights

Posterized posterized into [4] flat tonal bands, no smooth gradients

Color blocking color blocking: large hard-edged areas of solid [mustard], [cobalt] and [blush]

Overprint overprinted translucent inks: [pink] and [blue] overlap to make [purple]

Spot inks flat color separation in [5] spot inks: [ink] for [job], [ink] for [job]; no blended gradients

CMYK halftone visible CMYK halftone dots, comic-print texture

Iridescent iridescent holographic sheen shifting through pink, gold, mint and blue

Chromatic aberration slight chromatic aberration: red and cyan fringes on high-contrast edges

Glow & bloom soft bloom around highlights, light bleeding gently into the surroundings

UI & data color

Color tokens define colors as semantic tokens (background, surface, text, text-muted, border, accent, danger) as CSS variables

50-900 color scale build each color as a 50-950 scale; use 50-100 for backgrounds, 500-600 for accents, 800-900 for text

OKLCH build the palette in OKLCH so every hue at the same lightness has matching contrast

Tinted neutrals use warm stone neutrals (grays tinted slightly toward [brown]) for surfaces and text

Dark mode palette dark mode: #121417-ish background, off-white text, accents lightened and slightly desaturated, no pure black or white

Surface elevation in dark mode, show elevation by lightening surfaces step by step (background, card, menu, dialog)

Contrast ratio all text meets WCAG AA contrast (4.5:1 body, 3:1 large text and UI icons)

Don't rely on color alone never use color as the only signal; pair status colors with icons and text labels

Semantic status colors semantic status colors kept separate from the brand: success green, warning amber, danger red, info blue

State layers include hover (one step darker), pressed (two steps), visible focus ring, and 40%-opacity disabled states

Dynamic color generate a Material 3 dynamic color scheme from the seed color [#6750a4]

Categorical palette categorical palette of 6 distinct, equally prominent hues for unordered series

Sequential palette sequential single-hue palette from pale to dark [blue] for low-to-high values

Diverging palette diverging palette: [blue] for below zero, neutral gray at zero, [red] for above

Highlight one series all series in light gray except [our product], highlighted in the accent color

Okabe-Ito palette use the color-blind-safe Okabe-Ito palette (#e69f00, #56b4e9, #009e73, #f0e442, #0072b2, #d55e00, #cc79a7)

Viridis use the viridis colormap (purple to teal to yellow) for the continuous scale

Avoid rainbow scales no rainbow or jet colormaps; use a perceptually uniform ramp